

Day 3 — How Many 3×3 Magic Squares?

Module: Magic Squares — Bhadragaṇita (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Count the equivalence classes (up to symmetry).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *kothumi vidhi* (IAST: kothumi vidhi; lit. "Nārāyaṇa's algorithm for odd-order squares")
- How many ways can we make a 3×3 magic square?

Show the 2-7-6 / 9-5-1 / 4-3-8 square. Rotate the paper 90° — STILL magic! Rotate again — still! Reflect (mirror) — still!

"That's 8 ways! But they're all REALLY the same square — just turned around."

Children try rotating their own magic square paper. They count the rotations.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Class 3×3 Magic-Square Tournament* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.